Non-Finite Verbs

A non-finite verb (also known as a verbal) is the term used to describe a verb that does not indicate tense. The non-finite verbs are called gerunds, infinitives, and participles.

Finite verb	Non-Finite verb
A verb that indicates tense and changes according to the subject	A verb that does not indicate tense and does not change according to the subject

Finite verb:

Finite verbs change tense and number according to the subject.

Arun invited Suresh to his daughter's birthday.
Her friends presented the girl with a toy.
His friend presented a watch.

Non-finite verbs have no subject and do not change according to the tense or number. Non-finite verbs are broadly classified as follows:

i. Gerunds	1. Walking is a healthy habit *(Present participle used as a noun)*
ii. Infinitive	2. I like to walk early in the morning. *(to infinitive)*
iii. Present participle	3. These are my walking shoes. *(Present participle used as an adjective)*
iv. Past participle	4. Having walked a long distance I felt tired.

C. Look at the action words in bold. Identify whether they are either finite or non-finite verb.

They want to try a new approach.	
Trying is easy.	
Having tried everything , he gave up.	
All I can do is try.	
If she tried, she would succeed.	

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